

Index investing is an incredibly powerful vehicle to reach FI. JL Collins rightfully calls it “the simple path.” Save 50 percent of your income, invest in low-cost broad-based index funds for 10 to 15 years, and you’re done!!

Building ChooseFI and meeting so many entrepreneurs over the past two years have really opened my eyes to the power of entrepreneurship and how it can give you some of the benefits of FI long before you reach your number. Though I haven’t achieved FI, being my own boss means I have total control over my schedule.

The concept of the “Red X Month,” introduced on the podcast by Vincent Pugliese in episode 59, cemented this for me. If I wanted to take four weeks off for family reasons, I could put a red X through those dates on the calendar. Then I could work backward and build my schedule around that. I didn’t need to go through a manager to see what’s available after the senior employees choose their time off. I was working on the things I wanted to work on, and I felt like what I was working on had a greater purpose. Even more amazing was that my income had the potential to grow based directly on the work I